To Reviewer 2

First of all, thank you very much for the thoughtful and fair review. We did our best to address your concerns in the revised version. Below, we reproduce your comments (in black) and provide our answers in blue.

1. Are the objectives and the rationale of the study clearly stated?

The manuscript attributes lower delegation under personalization to perceived loss of choice authority. However, choice-authority salience is neither directly manipulated nor measured before the first delegation decision. The post-task expectation and reason measures are suggestive but cannot establish the psychological mechanism. The authors should either weaken the causal claims or provide stronger mechanism evidence.

This is a fair methodological point, thank you for pointing that out. We expanded the "Limitations" subsection to state explicitly that choice-authority salience was neither experimentally manipulated nor measured before participants' first delegation decision. Our case for the authority-based account rests on post-task expectation and reason measures together with the behavioral pattern they accompany (lower delegation despite higher expected accuracy). These are consistent with, but not on their own establishing, loss of choice authority as the operative mechanism. We now frame this throughout as the best-supported interpretation among those we can test, not a causally identified mechanism, and softened one overly strong sentence in "Theoretical implications" accordingly ("isolates" → "is most consistent with").

2. If applicable, is the application/theory/method/study reported in sufficient detail to allow for its replicability and/or reproducibility?

Yes [X] No [] N/A []
The EV and preference-based conditions differ simultaneously in personalization, perceived objectivity, decision criterion, profiling, and possibly expected financial performance. The results therefore establish a difference between two decision rules rather than a pure personalization effect.

We added a new limitations paragraph that lays out the confound explicitly (perceived objectivity, profiling, criterion, possibly expected performance) and then triangulates using evidence already in the paper: (i) Expected-performance account ruled out: participants in the preference-based condition expected the algorithm to match their preferences better, not worse, than the EV rule. Thus, lower delegation runs against, not with, differential performance expectations; (ii) profiling-aversion account unlikely to dominate: the profiling-related closed-item reason ("I don't like to be analysed by an algorithm") was selected far less often than responsibility- and authority-related items; (iii) perceived objectivity and the preference-based rule's explicit reference to the user's own prior judgment, precisely the dimension our choice-authority account targets. We note that these two cannot be fully separated with the present design and propose a concrete future manipulation (an objective rule that nonetheless explicitly uses the user's own data) to isolate them.

3. If applicable, are statistical analyses, controls, sampling mechanism, and statistical reporting (e.g., P-values, CIs, effect sizes) appropriate and well described?

Yes [X] No [] N/A []
Please report effect sizes and confidence intervals for the main outcomes, clarify preregistered versus exploratory analyses throughout, and provide robustness checks for repeated binary decisions.

We computed effect sizes and confidence intervals from the raw session data for all three primary/secondary results and added them to the text:

- Round-1 delegation: risk difference 11.1 pp (Wald 95% CI [−1.3, 23.7]); OR = 1.60 (Fisher's exact two-sided 95% CI [0.91, 2.84]). We stick to the standard convention of reporting two-sided CIs despite our one-sided hypotheses and briefly discuss the apparent `contradiction' of CIs including zero/one and the significant one-sided preregistered test.

- Average delegation (WMW): rank-biserial r ≈ 0.05 (bootstrap 95% CI [−0.10, 0.20]), i.e., a small effect whose CI comfortably spans zero, consistent with the null result.

- Categorical non-delegation: risk difference 12.3 pp (Wald 95% CI [4.9, 19.7]); OR = 5.25 (Fisher's exact 95% CI [1.65, 22.07]).

We also made explicit which feedback analyses were preregistered. In the process, we noticed and corrected an imprecision in our earlier version: the "Responses to feedback" subsection suggested that the win-stay/lose-shift model described first was the preregistered analysis; this was wrong. The preregistered secondary hypothesis was that, after delegating with a zero payoff, participants in the preference-based condition are more likely to switch to non-delegation in the next round than under any other circumstances, in particular than under the same circumstances in the EV condition. It is now reported first (not supported; interaction $\beta = -0.023$, SE = 0.067, one-sided $p = 0.633$). The win-stay/lose-shift model including its decomposition by who produced the prior outcome is labeled exploratory throughout.

As a robustness check for repeated binary outcomes, we re-estimated the preregistered LPM as a logistic regression with the same fixed effects and cluster-robust standard errors. The pattern is unchanged: the treatment coefficient and both interactions remain small and insignificant, while the zero-outcome history effect remains large, negative, and highly significant (OR = 0.19, $p < 0.001$). We added this to the text in the new footnote 6, confirming the LPM conclusions are not an artifact of the linear functional form.

4. Could the manuscript benefit from additional tables or figures, or from improving or removing (some of the) existing ones?
The authors find that delegation is initially lower in the preference-based condition, but that the two conditions converge in subsequent rounds. They interpret this pattern as being driven primarily by a stronger decline in delegation in the EV condition, potentially because the EV algorithm generates more zero-payoff outcomes and therefore loses more users over time. This is a very interesting finding and could substantially enrich the paper's distinction between initial adoption and continued use. However, the current evidence is largely descriptive, particularly Figure 2, and is not sufficient to support this causal interpretation.

Thank you very much for pressing us on this interpretation, as our resulting re-analysis led to further insights. First of all, we exploited realized-outcome variation within treatment in an additional analysis, which is not confounded by the between-treatment difference in decision rule. Conditional on having delegated in round 1, whether the realized payoff happened to be zero or positive is plausibly as-good-as-random (it depends on which lottery state was drawn). Within the EV condition, round-1 delegators who received a zero payoff delegated again in round 2 only 36.0% of the time, vs. 64.8% among those who received a positive payoff (two-sided Boschloo p = 0.020; OR = 0.31, 95% CI [0.10, 0.91] from Fisher's exact test). The same contrast in the preference-based condition has the same sign and a similar size (50.0% vs. 72.5%, Boschloo p =

0.078); the two contrasts do not differ significantly (interaction p = 0.772), and the weaker significance reflects the smaller number of round-1 preference-based delegators (62 vs. 79). We added this as new evidence, explicitly describing it as a within-treatment comparison that is considerably more direct than the pooled regression, while stopping short of calling it fully causal (realized payoffs are a function of the chosen lotteries, which in the PREFS treatment depend on the risk attitudes of the participants, which in turn are not exogenous).

Because the reaction to a zero payoff is very similar in both conditions, and because the realized difference in exposure to zero payoffs is small (40.3% vs. 36.2% of delegated decisions, participant-clustered p = 0.178), we no longer attribute the convergence to differential feedback as the submitted version did. The text now reports the exploratory decomposition described in our reply to Reviewer 3 (point 3) and grants that a substantial amount of the larger decline under EV remains unexplained.

5. If applicable, are the interpretation of results and study conclusions supported by the data?

Reviewer #2: Mark as appropriate with an X:
Yes [] No [X] N/A []

No further comments provided.

We take this as referring to the concerns raised in points 1–4 above, which we have addressed with (a) explicit, honest limitations language on what the mechanism evidence can and cannot establish, (b) a transparent account of the confounded dimensions and which can be ruled out, (c) effect sizes/CIs throughout, and (d) new within-treatment evidence that makes the feedback-driven interpretation of the convergence pattern considerably less purely descriptive. We hope these changes address the concern.

6. Have the authors clearly emphasized the strengths of their study/theory/methods/argument?

This manuscript investigates whether preference-based personalization increases users' willingness to delegate decisions to algorithms. Using a preregistered experiment, the authors find that participants are less willing to delegate to a personalized algorithm at first contact, although this difference disappears over repeated decisions. The topic is interesting.

Thank you very much for this positive assessment.

7. Have the authors clearly stated the limitations of their study/theory/methods/argument?

Yes, but the limitations should be expanded. The authors should acknowledge that the EV and preference-based treatments differ along several dimensions beyond personalization itself, and that subsequent feedback is partly treatment-generated.

We followed your advice as pointed out in points 2 and 4 above. We also added one clarification you may find useful: the "subsequent feedback is partly treatment-generated" concern applies to the feedback-driven convergence pattern in average delegation, but not to our two central results. The first-contact difference is measured before any outcome feedback exists, and categorical non-delegation describes participants who, by definition, never received algorithm-generated feedback at all. Hence, neither of our primary findings depends on comparing treatment-generated feedback content across conditions.

8. Does the manuscript structure, flow or writing need improving (e.g., the addition of subheadings, shortening of text, reorganization of sections, or moving details from one section to another)?

The manuscript could be shortened, particularly the Related Work and Discussion sections.

We agree and made a first conservative pass, getting rid of/trimming paragraphs in what used to be the “Study overview and supplementary analysis” subsection of the Introduction and the "Heterogeneity and contextual moderators," subsection of the Related Work. We further tightened the "Financial advice and robo-advisors" paragraph (by merging redundant sentences), and softening/tightening a sentence in "Theoretical implications." These are deliberately conservative cuts preserving all substantive content and citations, given that we weren’t sure which additional parts to cut without losing any of the other reviewers (who seemed to be happy with the length and contents, except that reviewer 1 wanted us to take the description of the task out of the main paper).

9. Could the manuscript benefit from language editing?

No

Happy to hear that, especially as the other reviewers seem to disagree.